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# LA renter emergency checklist

Earthquakes come without warning, fires can move in minutes, and heat waves strain the grid. Ten minutes today makes the first days much easier.

Scan for the full list and a free plan for your household

## 1. Sign up for alerts today

- [ ] **Sign up for NotifyLA** emergency.lacity.gov/notifyla
  Free texts, calls and emails from the City of Los Angeles about emergencies near the addresses you choose.
- [ ] **Register for Alert LA County** lacounty.gov/emergency
  The county's system. Use it too, especially if you live outside city limits or in an unincorporated area.
- [ ] **Get MyShake** myshake.berkeley.edu
  Free earthquake early warning from the ShakeAlert system. It can give you a few seconds to drop, cover and hold on before shaking arrives.
- [ ] **Find your evacuation zone** protect.genasys.com
  LA County issues evacuation warnings and orders by zone. Look up your address, write your zone down and keep it in your go-bag.

## 2. Keep at home, for each person

- [ ] **Water.** At least 3 gallons per person to start, then build to two weeks: about 14 gallons each. A major quake can break water mains for weeks.
- [ ] **Food.** Two weeks of food you can eat without cooking, and a manual can opener.
- [ ] **By every bed.** Sturdy shoes and a flashlight or headlamp. Broken glass is the most common earthquake injury.
- [ ] **Emergency toilet.** A bucket, heavy trash bags and cat litter. After a quake, don't flush until you know the sewer lines are OK.
- [ ] **Smoke.** N95 masks for everyone, for wildfire smoke and quake dust.
- [ ] **Medicine and papers.** A week or more of prescriptions, spare glasses, and copies of IDs, your lease and insurance.
- [ ] **Power and cash.** A charged power bank for each phone, and some cash in small bills.
- [ ] **Go-bag.** A packed bag by the door in case you have to leave fast for a fire.

## 3. Run a 10-minute building drill

- [ ] At night, with the lights off, walk from your bed to the nearest stairwell using a flashlight. Count the doors. Elevators won't run after a quake or in a fire.
- [ ] Practice drop, cover and hold on next to your bed, desk and couch.
- [ ] Find your unit's water shutoff, and ask where the building's gas shutoff and wrench are. Only shut off gas if you smell it or hear hissing.
- [ ] Pick a meeting spot outside your building and one outside the neighborhood.
- [ ] Swap numbers with two neighbors, and note who might need help: older neighbors, people with disabilities, families with babies.

## 4. Ask your landlord

- [ ] Is our building on the city's soft-story or concrete retrofit list, and is the work done? You can also look up the building's address on the LA Department of Building and Safety website.
- [ ] Is the water heater strapped? A falling water heater can start a fire or flood the unit.
- [ ] Where are the gas and water shutoffs, and who has the tools?
- [ ] Does every unit have working smoke alarms, and carbon monoxide alarms where there are gas appliances?

## 5. Check your insurance

Standard renters insurance usually doesn't cover earthquake damage. The California Earthquake Authority sells renters earthquake policies through participating insurers; ask your agent.

## 6. Write it down

Our evacuation zone _____

Meeting spot near home _____

Out-of-area contact _____

Neighbor's phone _____